

Jiixin An

Jiixin An

1616 Guadalupe St, Suite #5.202, Austin, TX 78701, U.S

Website: <https://jiixinan.github.io>

Email: jiixin.an@utexas.edu

Education

Ph.D. in Information Studies / The University of Texas at Austin

AUG 2021 - PRESENT, AUSTIN, TX

Advisor: Dr. Yan Zhang

Research Area: Health Informatics, Human-Computer Interaction, Information Behavior.

M.S., Library Science / Peking University

JUL 2018 - JUN 2020, BEIJING, CHINA

Advisor: Dr. Pengyi Zhang

Thesis: The health information behavior of parents of children with ASD (Autism Spectrum Disorder)

B.S., Library Science / Peking University

JUL 2014 - JUN 2018, BEIJING, CHINA

B.S., Psychology / Peking University

JUL 2015 - JUN 2018, BEIJING, CHINA

Industry Experience

Xiaomi Technology / User Research Intern

APR 2021 - JUL 2021, BEIJING, CHINA

- Explored the influence of voice assistants on mobile phone purchases by conducting a literature review, interviews, surveys, and online behavior data analyses.
- One of the early members to build the “Weibo public opinion monitoring” system for XiaoAI Assistant, including qualitative coding of posts in Weibo and cooperation with developers to automate coding with Machine Learning.
- The findings provide insights into the commercial strategies and optimization points of XiaoAI. The “Weibo public opinion monitoring” system was selected as one of the “Quality Star” programs in 2023.

Ferrum Health / User Research Intern

JUL 2018 - AUG 2018, SAN FRANCISCO, CA

- Conducted an interview study on Chinese physician attitudes toward AI CT scanners.
- The findings help the team understand the concerns of Chinese physicians on AI in medicine.
- This internship is funded by the CHINA-US Program for

Didi Chuxing / Product Manager Assistant

JUL 2017 - JAN 2018, BEIJING, CHINA

- Conducted data analysis with SPSS and SQL to support the algorithm design of order distribution
- Conducted an interview study on the user experience of ride-sharing drivers and riders

Research Experience

The University of Texas at Austin / Research Assistant

AUG 2021 - PRESENT, AUSTIN, TX

Project 1: Human-Centered Explainability in Interactive Information System

- PI: Dr. Jiqun Liu (University of Oklahoma) and Dr. Yan Zhang
- Researching the existing design of explainability by literature review

Project 2: The Application of Generative AI in Education

- PI: Dr. Wonchan Choi (University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee), Dr. Yan Zhang, and Dr. Besiki Stvilia (Florida State University)
- Investigating students' understanding and use of Generative AI in their study through interviews and qualitative coding

Project 3: Consumer Longitudinal Health Information Needs and Search Behavior

- PI: Dr. Yan Zhang and Dr. Jacek Gwizdka
- Conducting three-month data collection (interview, diaries, and log) for each participant and analyzing data with mixed methods.

Project 4: Fibromyalgia-Related Mobile App Use

- PI: Dr. Annie T. Chen (University of Washington)
- Researching mobile app usage of people with fibromyalgia with surveys and conducting statistical tests.

The University of Texas at Austin / Self-conducted project

JUN 2022 - present, AUSTIN, TX

Project: Conversational Agents (CAs) for Older Adults' Health

- Advisor: Dr. Yan Zhang
- Reviewing the existing research of CAs for assisting older adults' health

Peking University / Self-conducted project

JUL 2015 - JAN 2020, BEIJING, CHINA

Project 1: Information Behavior of Parents of Children with ASD

- Advisor: Dr. Pengyi Zhang
- Researching the information behavior of parents of children with ASD in caregiving through observation, interview, and qualitative analysis.

Project 2: Factors Influencing Emoji Usage in Smartphone-Mediated Communications

- Advisor: Dr. Pengyi Zhang
- Exploring emoji usage by collecting WeChat messages, qualitative coding, and statistical tests

Project 3: The Primary School Students' Internet Usage for Learning

- Advisor: Dr. Chang Liu
- Investigating students' Internet use during their study by diaries, focus groups, and qualitative coding

Publications

Work in Preparation

An, J., Kazmi, M., & Zhang, Y. (in preparation). Collaborative sense-making in people's everyday health information seeking: A longitudinal study.

An., J., Mittal, A., Chen, A., & Zhang, Y. (finalizing). Mobile App Use among Persons with Fibromyalgia.

An., J., Yi, S., & Zhang, Y. (in preparation). Conversational agents for older adults' healthcare: A systematic review.

Peer-Reviewed Long and Short Papers

An, J., Na, Y., & Zhang, P. (2019). How do parents of children with ASD use information grounds to seek for ASD-related information? *Proceedings of the Association for Information Science and Technology*, 56(1), 10-20.

An, J., Li, T., Teng, Y., & Zhang, P. (2018, March). Factors influencing emoji usage in smartphone mediated communications. In *International Conference on Information* (pp. 423-428). Springer, Cham.

Zhe, W., An, J., & Zhang, P. (2017). Activity patterns of collaborative sensemaking in small discussion groups. *iConference 2017 Proceedings* (pp. 498-506).

Peer-Reviewed Posters

Liu, J., An, J., & Zhang, P. (2020). Analyzing opinion conflicts in an online group discussion: From the perspective of majority and minority influence. *iConference 2020 Proceedings*.

An, J., Fu, Y., Wang, M., & Liu, C. (2017). To learn or not to learn? The primary school students' internet use for learning. *iConference 2017 Proceedings*.

Non-Archived Workshops

Jiaxin An. 2023. Resilience in parents' caregiving for children with ASD (Autism Spectrum Disorder): an exploratory study. In ACM Designing Interactive Systems (DIS) 2023 workshop - Designing for and Reflecting upon Resilience in Health and Wellbeing

Skills

- **Software:** Experienced using qualitative analysis software (e.g., NVivo), and statistical analysis software (SPSS). Familiar with design software (Axure, Sketch)
- **Research methods:** Experienced in qualitative methods, e.g., surveys,

observation, interviews, focus groups, and diaries. Familiar with quantitative methods, e.g., experiment design and statistical test.

- **Coding:** Basic knowledge of Python, SQL, HTML, CSS
- **Language:** Chinese, English.

Awards

University of Texas at Austin Graduate School Summer Fellowship (2023)

University of Texas at Austin College Recruitment Fellowship (2021 - 2022)

Excellent Award in the Graduate Student Symposium in ALIRG 2019

Dayuan Wu & Suiqiao Chen Scholarship, Peking University (Top 1 in library science) (2017)

Merit Student, Peking University (Top 10%) (2017)

“Challenge Cup” Academic Competition 2nd Prize, Peking University (2016)

Excellent volunteer, China Social Welfare Foundation (2016)